



GP2 REPORT- TEAM 36

PERSONAL PRODUCTIVITY AS A KEY SKILL FOR THE FUTURE OF WORK

Strategies For Professional Growth



METHODOLOGY

Research Design: Mixed-method approach combining secondary research with primary qualitative interviews to investigate personal productivity as a key future-of-work skill.

- **Phase 1 — Topic Finalization & Secondary Research** Reviewed academic journals (HBR, MIT Sloan), TED Talks, books (Covey, Newport, Drucker) and WEF Future of Jobs 2025 to build theoretical foundation across themes: time management, deep work, habit formation, and distraction management.
- **Phase 2 — Interview Design** Developed 11 semi-structured interview questions across 4 themes: productivity definition & measurement, daily habits & tools, hybrid work challenges, and future skills. Questions refined through team review and mock practice.
- **Phase 3 — Primary Data Collection** Each team member conducted one in-depth interview (20–25 min, online) with a working professional from a distinct industry — Healthcare IT, Property Insurance, IT Consulting, Education, and Software Engineering — ensuring cross-sector diversity.
- **Phase 4 — Thematic Analysis** Interview transcripts were analyzed to identify recurring patterns across all 5 responses. Key themes extracted: quality vs. speed, focus protection, AI augmentation, and hybrid work friction.
- **Phase 5 — Synthesis & Reflection** Findings were mapped against secondary literature to validate or challenge existing frameworks. Team held structured bi-weekly review meetings to ensure consistency, accuracy, and equal contribution.

Approach: Semi-structured qualitative interviews · Open-ended questions · Thematic coding · Tools: JIRA (task tracking) · Google Sheets (role allocation) · Google Meet (team meetings) · WhatsApp (daily updates) · Contingency: 2-day internal deadline buffer · Alternate Professional identified · Task Redistribution Protocol



ANALYSIS & RECOMMENDATIONS

ANALYSIS & KEY FINDINGS

Finding 1 — Productivity ≠ Being Busy

- All 5 respondents distinguished between activity and meaningful output
- Respondent 1 (21 yrs, Healthcare IT): daily self-check — "Did this task add business value?"
- Respondent 4 (8 yrs, Education): busy = emails & routine; productive = research & high-impact work
- Respondent 5 (20 yrs, Software Engg.): fast but buggy work creates rework — not productivity
- Secondary: Drucker (1999) — output ownership, not just hours logged

Finding 2 — Quality Over Speed

- Consistent across all 5 sectors — quality rated above delivery speed
- Respondent 2 (15 yrs, Insurance): monthly tracking of core vs. non-core task time
- Respondent 5 (20 yrs, Software Engg.): Agile story points + Definition of Done prevents rework
- Secondary: Kaplan & Mauch, MIT Sloan (2022) — sustainable productivity = quality, not volume

Finding 3 — Focus & Time Protection

- Respondent 3 (3 yrs, IT Consulting): dedicated focus hours — non-urgent messages blocked
- Respondent 4 (8 yrs, Education): time-blocking + first 30 min for emails to clear cognitive load
- Respondent 1 (21 yrs, Healthcare IT): time-boxed breaks — brief social media used as mental refresh
- Secondary: Newport (2019) — deep uninterrupted work is rare and therefore highly valuable

Finding 4 — AI Accelerates, Does Not Replace

- All 5 respondents use AI but unanimously agreed on its limits
- Respondent 1: AI handles ~25% of managerial tasks; people management remains irreplaceable
- Respondent 3: AI cannot understand client-specific edge cases or expectations
- Respondent 5: AI = "junior engineer" — human review needed for quality & system design
- Secondary: WEF Future of Jobs 2025 — human judgment & adaptability remain core future skills

Finding 5 — Hybrid Work: Freedom + Friction

- Respondent 2 (15 yrs, Insurance): office interaction enhances learning & mentorship
- Respondent 5 (20 yrs, Software Engg.): remote work → siloed behavior; virtual collab rooms improved productivity by 10–15%
- Respondent 3 (IT Consulting): excessive meetings consume full work days → focus hours become essential
- Secondary: George (2019, HBS) — collaborative environments improve individual & team performance

Finding 6 — Soft Skills = Productive Skills

- Respondent 1 (Healthcare IT): technical silos reduce team output even when individual work is strong
- Respondent 2 (Insurance): build SQL & Excel AND communication — both equally matter
- Respondent 5 (Software Engg.): map individual strengths → assign tasks → bridge skill gaps via training
- Secondary: Drucker (1999) — self-knowledge & interpersonal competence as critical as technical skill



ANALYSIS & RECOMMENDATIONS

RECOMMENDATIONS

RECOMMENDATION 1 — ADOPT A VALUE-BASED PRODUCTIVITY FILTER

- Before any task, ask: "Does this add value to my goal?"
- Drawn from Respondent 1 (21 yrs, Healthcare IT) — daily self-check practice
- Prevents the trap of being busy without being productive
- Apply during academic projects, internships, and team assignments
- Source: Drucker (1999) — output ownership over activity

RECOMMENDATION 2 — USE A TIERED TASK PRIORITIZATION SYSTEM

- Categorize all tasks into P1 (critical), P2 (important), P3 (low priority)
- Drawn from Respondent 3 (3 yrs, IT Consulting) — workplace prioritization practice
- Protects high-impact work from interruption and context-switching
- Skill underdeveloped in students — must be built before entering workforce
- Source: Covey (2004) — First Things First · time management matrix

RECOMMENDATION 3 — BUILD STRUCTURED DAILY & WEEKLY ROUTINES

- Start mornings with low-cognitive tasks (emails, messages) to clear mental load
- Reserve peak hours for deep work — block minimum 1–2 focus hours daily
- End each week with a reflection slot: "Did this week's work move the needle?"
- Drawn from Respondent 4 (8 yrs, Education) — time-blocking & weekly review practice
- Source: Kaplan & Mauch, MIT Sloan (2022) — sustainable productivity framework

RECOMMENDATION 4 — USE AI STRATEGICALLY, NOT REFLEXIVELY

- Use AI for repetitive tasks — drafting, citations, documentation, grammar checks
- Human judgment must govern client-facing work, edge cases & key decisions
- Respondent 1 (Healthcare IT): AI handles ~25% of managerial tasks — rest needs human oversight
- Respondent 3 (IT Consulting): AI cannot understand client-specific expectations
- Source: WEF Future of Jobs 2025 — critical thinking remains a top future skill

RECOMMENDATION 5 — TREAT COLLABORATION AS A PRODUCTIVITY SKILL

- Individual output alone is insufficient in team and workplace environments
- Respondent 5 (20 yrs, Software Engg.): virtual collaboration rooms → 10–15% productivity gain
- Prioritize clear communication, defined roles, and proactive information sharing
- For students: treat every group project as practice for workplace collaboration
- Source: George (2019, HBS) — collaborative environments directly improve performance

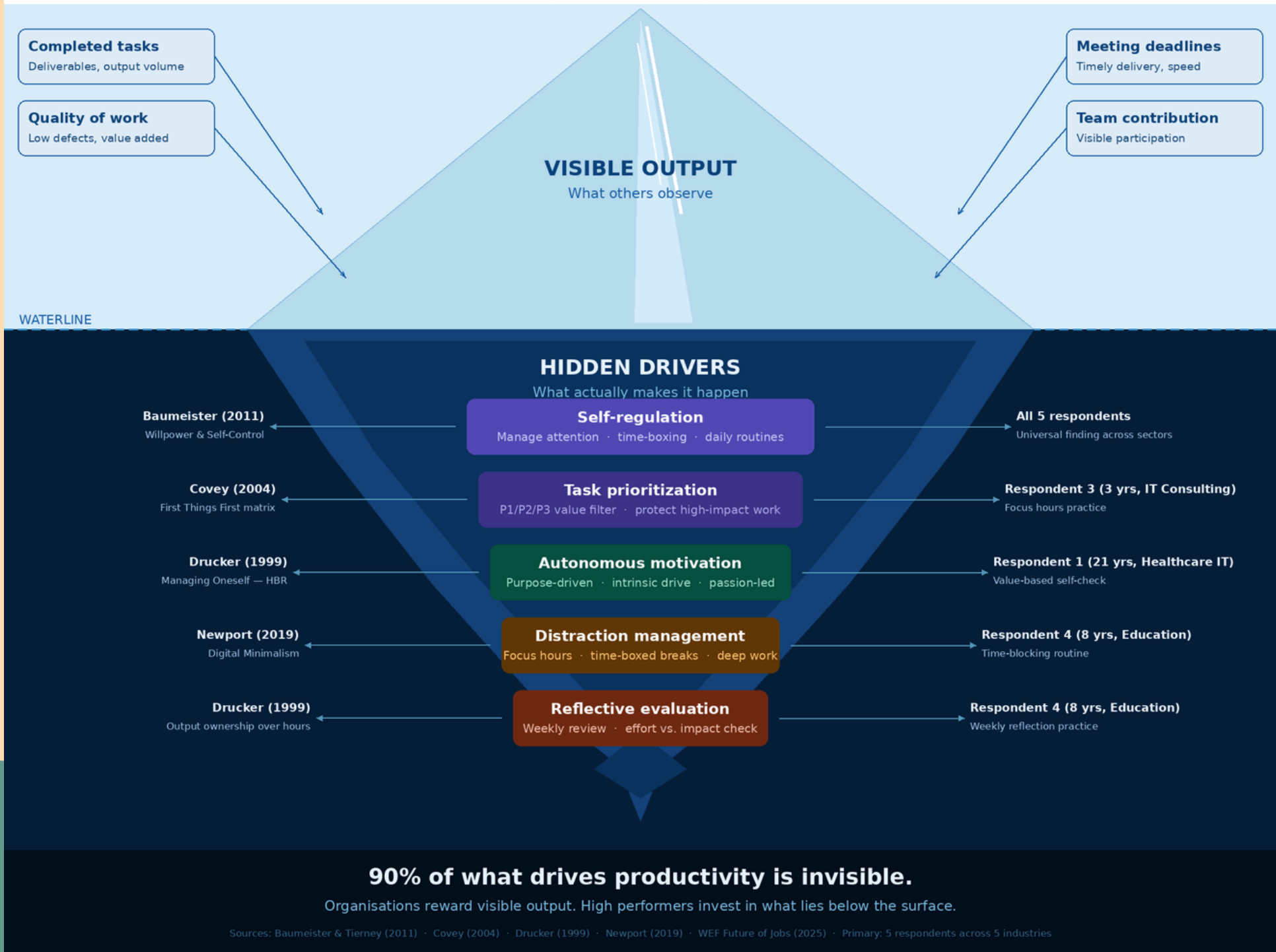
RECOMMENDATION 6 — CONTINUOUSLY INVEST IN TECHNICAL FOUNDATIONS

- Dedicate a portion of every workday to deliberate skill-building
- Respondent 2 (15 yrs, Insurance): 2 hrs out of 8-hr workday reserved for learning
- Build domain tools (SQL, Excel, relevant software) alongside communication skills
- Technical + soft skill balance is what separates average from high-performers
- Source: WEF 2025 — analytical thinking & tech literacy among top skills for 2030

INFLUENCE MODEL

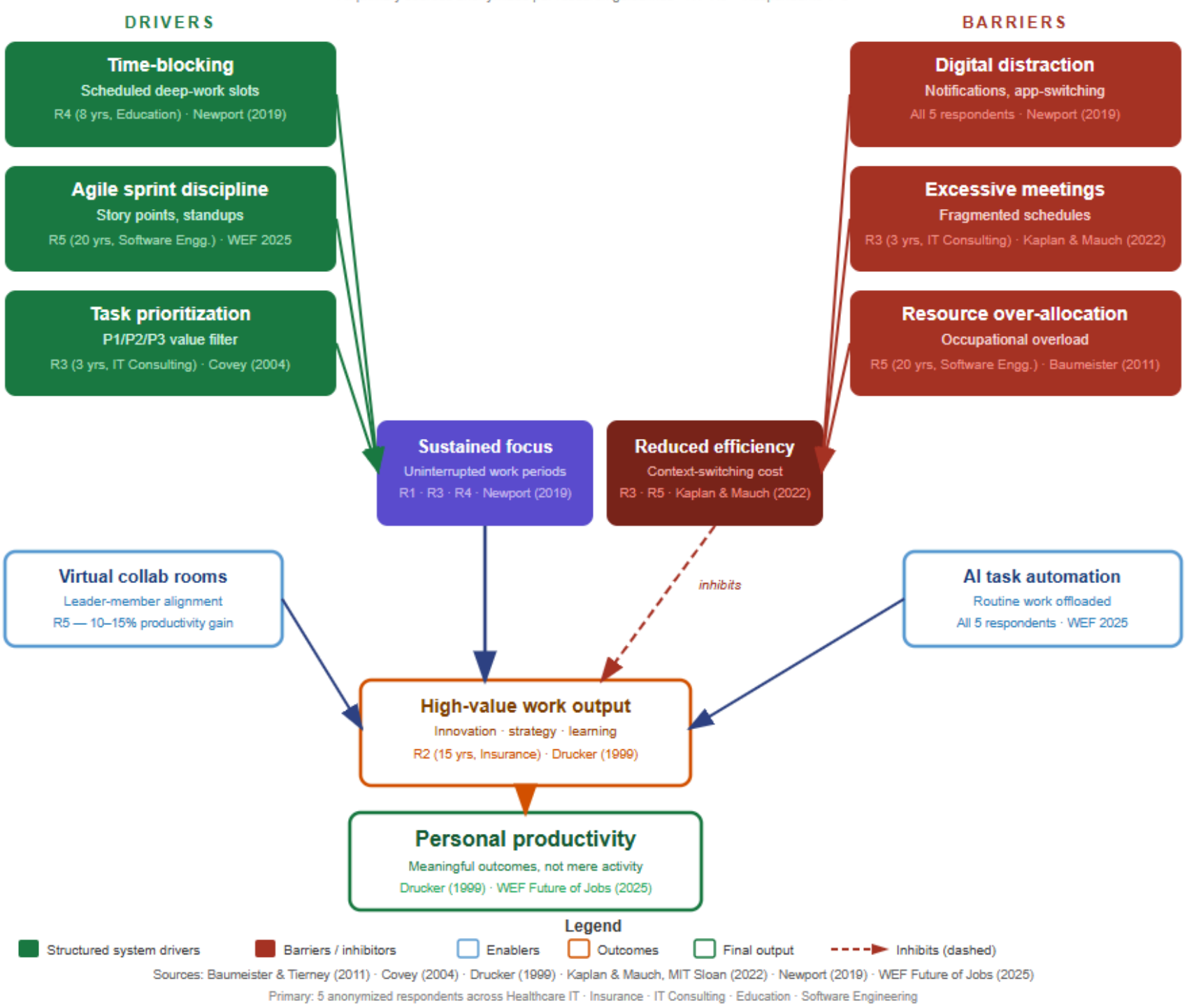
Personal Productivity — Iceberg Model

Team 36 · Strategies for Professional Growth · Jan 2026
What you see vs. what actually drives it



Personal Productivity — Influence Diagram

Team 36 · SPG Jan 2026 · Causal chain from drivers to productive outcome
All primary sources anonymized per research guidelines · R1–R5 = Respondents 1–5



PROJECT REVIEW AND CLOSURE

Nitya Sharma	Led overall project coordination, ensured timely progress, conducted interview with a working professional. Contributed to Team Contract, Project Management Plan, identification of interview participants,,updating project review and closure in gp2. Compilation and Documentation of Final reports in GP1 and GP2
Ashish Raj	Conducted an interview and contributed to the analysis section. Supported report integration, Team Contract, team personality profile compilation, and developed interview insights and research findings.
Rasiga. B	Conducted interview and prepared report drafts. Contributed to drafting interview questions, methodology section in GP2, Team Contract, and identification of interview participant in GP1.
Vinil Vasukuttan	Assisted in model creation and report structuring. Contributed to secondary research and WEF alignment, Team Contract, identification of interview participants in GP1, Application/Influence Model in GP2 and conducted interview.
Digvijaysinh S Chudasama	Contributed to Team Contract, Project Management Plan, recommendations, and conducted interview.

Challenges Faced

- Difficulty in scheduling interviews with professionals.
- Managing time alongside academic commitments.
- Coordinating tasks and ensuring timely submissions from all team members.
- Balancing depth of analysis within a tight 5-slide constraint

Best Practices:

- Clear division of tasks and responsibilities from the beginning. Use JIRA board and Google Sheets for parallel task tracking.
- Regular follow-ups and team communication ensured smooth progress.
- Early initiation of interviews helped avoid last-minute delays.
- Bi-weekly structured meetings with pre-shared agendas ensured no one fell behind
- 2-day internal deadline buffer before submission prevented last-minute quality issues
- Peer review cycles before each submission stage maintained consistency in tone and quality

Recommendations:

- Start data collection and interviews as early as possible.
- Maintain buffer time before the final deadline for editing and review.
- Ensure active participation and accountability from all team members.